

# We read 869 ads. Here is the one-page version.

Twelve months of Meta advertising — yours, and every brand competing for the same parents and the same franchise buyers.

**Window:** Aug 2025 – Jul 2026 · **Source:** Meta Ad Library (public) + FKI FDD library · **Brands tracked:** Cookie Cutters, Sharkey's, Pigtales & Crewcuts, Snip-its, plus 20 cross-shopped concepts

869

ads captured and classified across the category

272

Cookie Cutters ads, from 35 franchisee-owned accounts

0

of those 272 that sell a franchise

82

franchise-recruitment ads Sharkey's ran in the same window

COMPETING FOR THE FRANCHISE BUYER

Sharkey's is recruiting owners hard. You are not in the channel.

WHAT SHARKEY'S RUNS

82 franchise ads in 12 months — three of them launched July 26–27, two days before this review. The angles: absentee ownership, "40 new locations in the next 12 months," "approaching 300 locations," and a founder origin story.

WHAT EVERYONE ELSE RUNS

Of the 20 brands a \$150K–\$400K candidate cross-shops against you, only two advertise ownership on Meta at all. Eighteen are dark. This is the cheapest franchise-development channel available right now, and it is nearly empty.

WHAT COOKIE CUTTERS RUNS

Zero. Not one of the 272 ads recruits a franchisee. Corporate is absent from paid social entirely — every ad in the system comes from a franchisee's own page, so there is no brand-level voice and no franchise-development voice anywhere in the channel.

COMPETING FOR THE HAIRCUT CUSTOMER

You built the experience. Sharkey's is the one advertising it.

WHAT SHARKEY'S RUNS

88% of their consumer ads lead with the in-store experience — the TVs at every chair, the cars to sit in, the play area. Your stores have the same assets.

WHAT COOKIE CUTTERS RUNS

The same rooms appear in 2% of your ads. 87% are a generic "book now" that competes on convenience alone. Social proof runs in 2 of 272. Birthday parties, sensory-friendly service and the membership run in none. And your 35 owners advertise seven conflicting price points against each other — a parent who passes two of your stores sees two prices for the same haircut.

WHERE YOU ARE ALREADY WINNING

First haircut and the keepsake. You index at 29% of ads on it; Sharkey's is at 2%, Pigtales 4%. You own the most emotional moment in the category. Press it harder.

## Three things you already own that have never run as an ad

The membership program

Your own pilot: 83% more visits per member, and \$170 vs \$111 in annual revenue per customer. Live in 15 stores. It is the direct answer to the visit-frequency drop you described — and it buys the visit back instead of discounting it.

0 OF 272 ADS

The Snip-its acquisition

159 locations. The largest children's salon platform in the country — your words, in your own press release, nine months ago. It outranks anything Sharkey's can claim about scale.

0 OF 272 ADS

The lowest entry cost in the category

A \$117,000 floor, below every direct competitor, plus a declining multi-unit fee ladder — \$40K, then \$20K, then \$10K. Unusual, and aimed straight at the operator who never stops at one store.

0 OF 272 ADS

What is in the full review, already written and waiting for you

30 ADS SPECIFIED

Ten franchise-recruitment statics, two aimed at the ~80 existing owners who are your cheapest next franchise sale, six consumer, two hiring, and ten videos — every one producible from assets you already have or a single half-day shoot. Each is written, named, and reasoned, starting with the counter-punch to "approaching 300": America's largest children's salon platform.

What we can and cannot see.

This was built entirely from Meta's public Ad Library, which shows every ad, its copy and its launch date — but not spend, impressions or cost per result. So every claim above about what an ad says is fact and traces to a Meta Library ID; nothing here claims to know what performed. Competitor investment figures are aggregator-derived and flagged approximate, and no Item 19 earnings figure appears anywhere — we could not verify one against a primary registry filing, and we will not put a number in front of you that we cannot source. Thirty minutes of reporting access inside your ad accounts turns all of this into a ranked list by real cost per booking.